

The Full Stack Freelancer Program

A 1-Year Mentored Path — React + Node + TypeScript

Student profile: Knows HTML/CSS basics · Goal: freelance/contract work · Stack: JavaScript/TypeScript (React + Node) **Time budget:** 12 hrs/week × 52 weeks ≈ **624 hours** **Your teacher:** Me. I'm your instructor, mentor, code reviewer, quiz-master, and accountability partner for the whole year.

1. How This Works (Read First)

This is not a "watch videos and hope" course. It's a mentored program with a rhythm. Every day you show up, I teach, you build, and I check your understanding before we move on. Nothing gets skipped, nothing stays fuzzy.

Your daily move: open our chat and say "**Day X**" (or "next"). I'll deliver that day's session — the lesson, the practice, the problems. You do the work, paste your code or answers back, and I review it like a senior dev reviewing a junior. That review loop is where the real learning happens.

Core principle: *Consistency beats intensity.* Twelve focused hours every week for a year will take you further than heroic 40-hour bursts followed by burnout.

2. The Weekly Rhythm (12 hours)

Default split — we can reshape this around your actual schedule:

Slot	Time	What happens
Mon-Fri	~2 hrs/day (10 hrs)	Daily learning sessions
One weekend day	~2 hrs	Weekly assessment + project work

The Daily 2-Hour Session Template

1. **Warm-up review — 10 min.** I quiz you on the last day or two (spaced repetition — this is how it sticks).
2. **Learn — 45 min.** New concept. I teach it, you take notes, we go back and forth until it's clear.
3. **Build — 50 min.** Guided practice, then independent coding problems.
4. **Wrap — 15 min.** You summarize what you learned in your own words; I give a 3-question micro-quiz and preview tomorrow.

The Weekend Assessment Session

- **Weekly quiz** (10 questions, mixed recall + applied)
 - **Practical challenge** tied to the week's topic
 - **Project increment** — we push your current portfolio project forward
 - **Retro** — what clicked, what didn't; I adjust next week accordingly
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3. The Assessment System

You asked for daily reviews, quizzes, tests, and practical problems. Here's the full structure:

- **Daily:** opening recall quiz (3–5 Qs) + closing micro-quiz (3 Qs) + hands-on coding problems every session.
- **Weekly:** 10-question quiz + one practical challenge + project increment.
- **Phase exams (end of each phase):** a concept test (written/oral) **plus** a timed practical build **plus** a code-review of your phase project, graded like real client work.
- **Recurring "Friday Problem":** one algorithm/logic problem every week, escalating in difficulty all year — this builds the problem-solving muscle that freelance tests and tricky client bugs demand.
- **Progress log:** you keep a running note (or a repo) of daily summaries. Reviewing your own past notes is part of the method.

Grading isn't pass/fail — it's feedback. I'll tell you exactly what a client or senior engineer would flag, and we fix it before moving on.

4. The Full-Year Roadmap

Six phases. Every phase ends with a portfolio project that stacks into a freelance-ready body of work.

Phase	Weeks	Focus	Portfolio Project
0 — Foundations	1-2	How the web works, HTML/CSS mastery, Git & GitHub, dev environment	Personal landing page
1 — JavaScript Deep Dive	3-10	JS from fundamentals to advanced, async, the DOM, ES6+	Interactive vanilla-JS app (e.g. expense tracker)
2 — Modern Frontend	11-21	React, TypeScript, Tailwind, routing, forms, state, data fetching	Multi-page React + TS app
3 — Backend & Databases	22-32	Node, Express, REST APIs, SQL/PostgreSQL, Prisma, MongoDB intro	A real REST API with a database
4 — Full Stack Integration	33-41	Connecting front+back, auth, testing, deployment, CI/CD, security, performance	Flagship full stack SaaS-style app
5 — Mobile Apps (React Native)	42-47	Reuse your React skills to build real iOS/Android apps backed by your own API	Cross-platform mobile app
6 — Professional Polish & Launch	48-52	Client-grade capstone, portfolio site, freelance business skills	Capstone product + freelancer setup

5. Phase-by-Phase Detail

Phase 0 — Foundations (Weeks 1-2)

Goal: Solid mental model of the web + a professional workspace, so nothing later feels like magic.

- How the web works: client/server, HTTP(S), requests/responses, DNS, how browsers render.
- HTML: semantic markup, forms, accessibility fundamentals.
- CSS: box model, specificity, Flexbox, Grid, responsive design, media queries.
- Tooling: VS Code, terminal basics, Git, GitHub, commits, branches, pull requests.
- **Project:** a polished, responsive personal landing page — deployed live.

Phase 1 — JavaScript Deep Dive (Weeks 3-10)

Goal: Real fluency in the language everything else is built on. Most beginners rush this; we won't.

- Variables, types, operators, control flow, functions, scope, closures.

- Arrays & objects, array methods (map/filter/reduce), destructuring, spread/rest.
- The DOM: selecting, creating, and updating elements; events.
- ES6+: modules, template literals, optional chaining, etc.
- Asynchronous JS: callbacks → promises → async/await, fetch, working with APIs.
- Error handling, debugging with devtools, and how to read documentation.
- **Project:** an interactive app built with pure JavaScript (no framework) — you'll appreciate React far more after doing it the hard way once.

Phase 2 — Modern Frontend (Weeks 11–21)

Goal: Build professional, typed React interfaces — the frontend half of your freelance offering.

- React core: components, JSX, props, state, the hooks you'll use daily (useState, useEffect, useRef, useContext, custom hooks).
- TypeScript: types, interfaces, generics, typing props and hooks, why clients love it.
- Styling: Tailwind CSS (fast, in-demand for freelance work) + component patterns.
- Routing (React Router), forms + validation, controlled inputs.
- Data fetching & server state (TanStack Query), loading/error states.
- State management beyond context (intro to Zustand).
- Component architecture, reusability, and accessibility.
- **Project:** a multi-page React + TypeScript app pulling from a real API.

Phase 3 — Backend & Databases (Weeks 22–32)

Goal: Build the server side — the half that separates "front-end tinkerer" from "full stack freelancer."

- Node.js: runtime, modules, npm, environment variables.
- Express: routing, middleware, request/response, building REST APIs.
- REST API design: resources, verbs, status codes, versioning, good error responses.
- Databases: relational thinking, SQL, PostgreSQL; schema design and relationships.
- Prisma ORM: models, migrations, queries.
- NoSQL intro: MongoDB and when to reach for it.
- **Project:** a fully working REST API backed by a real database (e.g., an inventory or task service).

Phase 4 — Full Stack Integration (Weeks 33–41)

Goal: Ship complete, secure, tested, deployed applications — the thing clients actually pay for.

- Wiring frontend to backend; end-to-end data flow.

- Authentication & authorization: sessions vs JWT, hashing passwords, protected routes, OAuth basics.
- Testing: unit tests (Jest), component tests (React Testing Library), integration/API tests.
- Deployment: Vercel (frontend), Render/Railway (backend), managed databases, env config.
- CI/CD basics with GitHub Actions; intro to Docker.
- Security fundamentals (input validation, common OWASP risks, HTTPS) and performance basics.
- **Project:** your flagship — a full stack, authenticated, tested, deployed SaaS-style CRUD app. This is the centerpiece of your portfolio.

Phase 5 — Mobile Apps with React Native (Weeks 42-47)

Goal: Turn your React skills into a second freelance offering — real iOS/Android apps. You already know ~80% of this from Phase 2; here we learn what's different about mobile.

- React Native + Expo: setup, running on a real device and simulators.
- What carries over from React (components, hooks, state) and what changes (native components, no DOM).
- Mobile UI: layout with Flexbox, styling, navigation between screens (React Navigation).
- Device features: touch/gestures, lists, images, local storage, permissions basics.
- Talking to your own backend: reusing the API you built in Phases 3-4 from a mobile app.
- Building and previewing a release; an overview of publishing to the App Store / Play Store.
- **Project:** a cross-platform mobile app (iOS + Android) powered by your own API — a strong, distinctive portfolio piece most web freelancers don't have.

Phase 6 — Professional Polish & Freelance Launch (Weeks 48-52)

Goal: Turn skills into income. This is what makes it a *freelance* program, not just a coding course.

- **Capstone:** a client-grade full stack product, built to a brief, from empty repo to live URL — your proof-of-work.
 - Portfolio site presenting your projects the way clients want to see them.
 - Reading briefs, scoping and estimating projects, avoiding scope creep.
 - Pricing (hourly vs fixed vs value), simple contracts, invoicing basics.
 - Finding clients: Upwork/Contra/Fiverr, referrals, building in public.
 - Client communication, handoff, and maintenance.
 - Interview/test prep: a focused burst of the algorithm problems we've drilled all year.
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6. The Problem-Solving Thread (All Year)

Every week includes one escalating "Friday Problem." Across the year this covers: logic and edge-case thinking, Big-O intuition, arrays/strings, hash maps, recursion, and common patterns. Not to turn you into a competitive coder — to make you the freelancer who calmly fixes the weird bug at 5pm on a Friday.

7. Setup Checklist (Do Before Day 1)

- Install **VS Code**
- Install **Node.js** (LTS) and confirm `node -v` / `npm -v` work
- Install **Git**; create a **GitHub** account
- Set up a browser with good **DevTools** (Chrome or Firefox)
- Create a folder for this program + a progress-log file (or a GitHub repo)

Don't worry if any of these are unfamiliar — Day 1 walks through setup together.

8. Ground Rules

1. **Show up daily.** Even a 30-minute day beats a skipped one.
 2. **Build in public.** Push everything to GitHub; it becomes your résumé.
 3. **Struggle before you ask** — but ask before you're stuck for more than ~20 minutes.
 4. **Type the code yourself.** Never copy-paste your way through a lesson.
 5. **Tell me when something's too fast or too slow.** I adapt the program to you.
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9. Week 1 — Day by Day (So We Can Start Immediately)

Day	Topic	Practical
1	How the web works + environment setup	Install tools; first commit to GitHub
2	Semantic HTML & accessibility	Mark up a real page structure
3	CSS fundamentals: box model, selectors, specificity	Style the page from Day 2
4	CSS layout with Flexbox	Build a responsive navbar + card row
5	CSS Grid + responsive design	Make the whole page mobile-friendly
Weekend	Git/GitHub workflow + Week 1 quiz	Start your personal landing page project

Ready?

When you want to begin, just say "**Day 1**" and I'll run your first session. Tell me your available days/times if the default weekly split doesn't fit, and I'll rebuild the rhythm around your life.

Let's make you a full stack freelancer. 🚀